

only if a file is incurable does the user have the option to either quarantine or delete the file. The user can choose whether to heal a file automatically during a scan (from the Program Settings, under the Service menu). If this is disabled, AVG does not allow the user to heal any



The various settings for the Resident Shield of AVG

infected file during a scan—the only options are to delete and quarantine. The Heal button in the scan window is greyed out, and may be available only in the paid version. Besides the scanner, AVG also has an e-mail virus-checking module.

AVG, too, has updates almost daily, and the process can be managed within the application. The user has two update options: either online updating, or from a folder. This ability to update from a folder is quite useful for people who do not have Net access.

The AVG control panel lists the program components. Under the Resident Shield link, the real-time scanning behaviour can be set. File extensions that can be skipped can be indicated here. This is an important time-saving option, since viruses like virtob only infect EXE files, and the scanning of the rest of the files can be avoided.

5.5 Firewalls

5.5.1 Introduction

Firewalls are devices—software and hardware—that prevent unauthorised entry into a system. Any network interface has 65,535 possible points of connection (these are called ports). When a PC is connected to the network, these ports are accessible by any other PC on the network. This presents an opportunity for those with “malafide” intentions to access the contents of a PC without permission. A firewall usually operates by blocking or monitoring all